

S01-04 - The First Roll

Player read-aloud

The strixwolf lowers her head. Her feathers rise along her spine. The pups go still.
What do you do?

Scene summary

The first action roll determines whether the strixwolf calms, retreats, snaps, or trusts.

Visible choices

- Roll Presence
- Use food or magic
- Let ranger/animal expert approach
- Strike first

Player questions

- What detail in The First Roll tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

GM notes

- Track Strixwolf Mercy. Good treatment can pay off as warning before the Bramble Union ambush.
- Keep player-facing information actionable. Reveal systemic truth through objects, reactions, and consequences before naming it.
- Manufactured-threat lens: seed the contradiction, do not explain it. The surface goal stays simple and heroic.

Checks and rolls

- Any relevant approach Resolve fallout from the creature encounter. Easy to hard by choice Record trust, blood debt, or neutral outcome. 20 Cleanly resolve: Resolve fallout from the creature encounter. Add a concrete boon, extra clue, or improved position. Success, plus the player names one helpful detail or asks one follow-up question. Success, but the GM exposes a cost, ticks a countdown, or reveals a new pressure tied to The First Roll. The full goal slips, but the party still learns a useful truth or avoids the worst consequence. The GM makes a hard move that follows from the fiction and leaves the next choice visible. Spend Fear to reveal omitted risk, split attention, or put a human cost in front of the contract. On mixed or sliding results, reveal information in layers: visible fact, actionable clue, then systemic truth.

Clues

- Feather token A sign of danger. GM can use it to foreshadow the ambush. Only appears if mercy was shown.

Loot

- Feather warning token
- Recovered cart supply

Mechanics

- Plot So Far: The party is in Act One pressure: The first action roll determines whether the strixwolf calms, retreats, snaps, or trusts.
- Mechanics In Play: Use Daggerheart Duality Dice as baseline. Use the listed Difficulty and outcome options when a roll matters. Keep trivial actions no-roll; roll only when uncertainty, cost, or danger is interesting.
- Roll Cards: s01-04-make-the-first-meaningful-roll-matter S01-04 Make the first meaningful roll matter Make the first meaningful roll matter Presence Instinct Presence Instinct 12 This is the teaching roll: ask what the PC does, choose the trait, then show Hope/Fear. The table learns that the roll changes the fiction, not just pass/fail. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that...
- Gm Fear Spends: Make the safe road feel less safe: noise, scent, cracked wheel, or cargo hum. Separate evidence from assumption so a monster read is tempting but incomplete.
- Conditions Hazards: No official condition unless a feature, hazard, or fictional position calls for Hidden, Restrained, or Vulnerable.
- Search Loot Clues: No fixed loot. Offer clue, texture, or hospitality only when the fiction supports it.
- No Roll Guidance: Do not call for a roll when the players have time, a clear method, and no meaningful pressure.
- Escalation: Escalate by making cost visible: time, noise, trust, ward instability, or someone vulnerable in danger.
- Deescalation: De-escalate through respect, care, honest testimony, useful evidence, or a concrete concession.
- Tv Mechanics Caption: Public cue: The First Roll asks what the party does, what it costs, and who is protected.
- Trait Variety Note: Primary traits in this scene: Instinct, Presence. If rolls drift toward Instinct/Presence, ask whether Agility, Strength, Finesse, or Knowledge better describes the action.
- Class Community Ancestry Reveals: Loreborne: spots older legal, heraldic, or ward-

craft language under the branding. Underborne: notices service doors, hidden routes, and who built the thing nobody credits. Highborne: reads etiquette, class panic, and reputational risk. Ridgeborne: notices stonework, weight, pressure, and structural weakness. Wildborne: reads the land, animals, and local ecological stress. Elf/Ribbet/Human/Giant/Katari: invite one sensory or social detail from the player's heritage. Sorcerer/Rogue/Warrior/Guardian/Ranger: give each class one table-facing way to shine without changing the plot.

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